

Publications

(making it seem more impressive than it is because it's all I got)

- [1] **Hieu M Vu** and Tan Minh Nguyen. “[Angular Steering: Behavior Control via Rotation in Activation Space](#)”. In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)* (2025). **Spotlight (top 3.5%)**.
- [2] Dung V Nguyen*, **Hieu M Vu***, Nhi Y Pham*, Lei Zhang, and Tan M Nguyen. “[Activation Steering with a Feedback Controller](#)”. In: *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)* (2026).
- [3] Nguyen Hong Son, **Hieu M Vu**, Tuan-Anh D Nguyen, and Minh-Tien Nguyen. “[Jointly Learning Span Extraction and Sequence Labeling for Information Extraction from Business Documents](#)”. In: *International Joint Conference on Neural Networks (IJCNN)*. **Oral**. IEEE. 2022, pp. 1–8.
- [4] Tuan-Anh D Nguyen, **Hieu M Vu**, Nguyen Hong Son, and Minh-Tien Nguyen. “[A Span Extraction Approach for Information Extraction on Visually-Rich Documents](#)”. In: *Document Analysis and Recognition-ICDAR Workshops: Lausanne, Switzerland, September 5–10, 2021, Proceedings, Part II 16*. **Best Paper Award**. Springer. 2021, pp. 353–363.

Experience

(trying to up-sell myself)

Research Fellow

Jan 2026 — Present

ML Alignment and Theory Scholars (MATS)

Berkeley, CA, USA

Participating in the Anthropic Fellows Program via MATS, working on AI Safety research.

Independent Researcher

June 2024 — Present

- Self-directed research on LLM interpretability, focusing on understanding and controlling the activation space of LLMs.
- Published a paper [1] on fine-grained and robust control of LLM behaviours via activation steering.
- Visited the National University of Singapore (funded) to collaborate with Prof. Tan Nguyen on mathematically grounded activation steering methods [2].

AI Research Engineer

July 2024 — Present

Torilab

- **Building AI avatars:** Research on activation steering for controlling LLMs’ behaviours; developing the core chatbot framework with memory, tool use, and multi-turn interactions; LLM fine-tuning (SFT, DPO) and serving (vLLM, sglang).

AI Research Engineer

Nov 2018 — May 2024

Cinnamon AI

- Co-creator of [kotaemon](#) (25.2k+ ★): An open-source tool for local RAG application built for both end users and developers.
- **Document Image Understanding:** Information Extraction and cross-lingual adaptive pre-training for Japanese. Introduced new IE models that became the standard for client projects (+2–7% f1-score) [4, 3].

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Aug 2017 — Sep 2019

IOT Lab, UET - Vietnam National University

- Predictive models for wellbore data: facies classification, time-series analysis, permeability regression, cumulative and federated learning.

Education

(grade is just a number and I got lucky)

Bachelor Degree, Computer Science (Honours Programme)

2020

UET - Vietnam National University, Hanoi

GPA: 3.83/4.00 (Rank: =1st/600+)

- **Highest Ranking Graduate.**

Honours and Awards

(more uncomfortably showing off)

Best Paper Award

Sep 2021

ICDAR 2021, Workshop on Document Images and Language

Paper title: [A Span Extraction Approach for Information Extraction on Visually-Rich Documents](#)

Accepted for oral presentation and awarded the Best Paper Award at Workshop on Document Images and Language, ICDAR 2021.

Certificate of Highest Ranking Graduate

Aug 2020

UET - Vietnam National University

Awarded to students who graduated with the highest GPA amongst the graduating class.

Top 4 Zalo AI Challenge 2018 - Voice Track (Individual participant)

Sep 2018

Zalo, VNG Corporation

Finished at 4th place on the Private Leaderboard of the Voice Gender/Accent Classification challenge.

[Zalo AI Challenge](#) is an annual Kaggle-like competition hosted by Zalo - one of the biggest tech companies in Vietnam. In 2018, the competition attracted over 700 teams competed in 3 challenges.

Skills

(for those bots that love keywords)

Technical Fields	LLMs, ML Interpretability, Activation Steering, RAG, Agentic AI, Information Extraction, Document Understanding, NLP, Computer Vision, Image Processing, Time-series Analysis.
ML/AI Tools	Pytorch, Transformers, vLLM, sglang, LangChain, Haystack, LlamaIndex, Tensorflow/Keras, Scikit-learn, OpenCV.
Software Development	Git, Github Action, Docker, CircleCI, DVC.
Programming Languages	Python, C/C++, Java, Shell Script.
Industrial Domains	Insurance, Manufacturing, Virtual Companion.
Environments	GCP, AWS, Linux, Windows/WSL.
Natural Languages	Vietnamese (native), English (IELTS 7.5), Japanese (JLPT N4).
Other	Research (Google Scholar), Problem Solving (Leetcode).